



# Of designing games

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**N**early all of us have played video games as children. But have you ever wondered how such a complex piece of software is made? What kind of knowledge and skills are required to make such a “good” game? Well, if you have ever wanted to do the same, maybe you would want to look at game design as a career. Interested? Read on!

## What it is, what it isn't

Game design is the craft of knowing how hurling disgruntled birds on a stack of pigs can actually be fun to millions of people on the planet while making

The rising popularity of gaming has drawn immense interest in game development as a lucrative career option. But what does it take to be a successful game designer?

a franchise worth billions of dollars. Well... kind of.

Academically speaking, you could say that Game Design is an art and a science.

It is the art of envisioning the storyline, content and rules of a game; while it is the science of examining the psychology of the player and his relationship with the game. In short, game design involves figuring out what will get a player hooked to a game and what won't... and creating games that will work.

So who is the mastermind that uses game design theories to create a successful game? (drumroll please): the Game Designer.

A Game Designer is someone who has a vision of what the game is like as it goes through iterations in its cycles of development. Any game you see in the market is usually the brainchild of a Game Designer. You could say that he is the one who makes sure that a Half life game plays and feels like a Half life game. He doesn't design the artwork or do the programming; he is to a game what a director is to a movie—he can make or break a game concept.

In fact, contrary to popular belief, Game Design doesn't just mean designing video games for PC / Consoles... it could also mean designing board, card or live action games. Game Design is also used by companies to ‘gamify’ less interesting activities for their employees or customers.

## Myths and expectations

So, first things first: Game Design isn't Programming. Game Design isn't Character Design or Animation. Game Design isn't Story Writing for Games and Game Design surely isn't Game Testing. If you have been a die-hard gamer and you think you would want to make games because you can play games—you would be disappointed to know that it doesn't qualify you to become a Game Designer. Yes, being a gamer does help. However, a Game Designer has to enter the industry with minimal bias towards all kinds of games; Games that are played by players from varied age groups, genders and geographies; on varied platforms and with varied play times.

As a Game Designer it is unlikely that your first project will be God of War 4 or a Huge AAA blockbuster title. It is likely, that at the start you may be working for studio as a Trainee or Associate Game Designer. Most Game Designers have to start off on smaller Design tasks like balancing how much gold a player gets in a certain area of a game or designing levels in projects before they are proven and are given the responsibility of envisioning the entire Game. Let's face it, you are new and a lot of time and money is at stake.